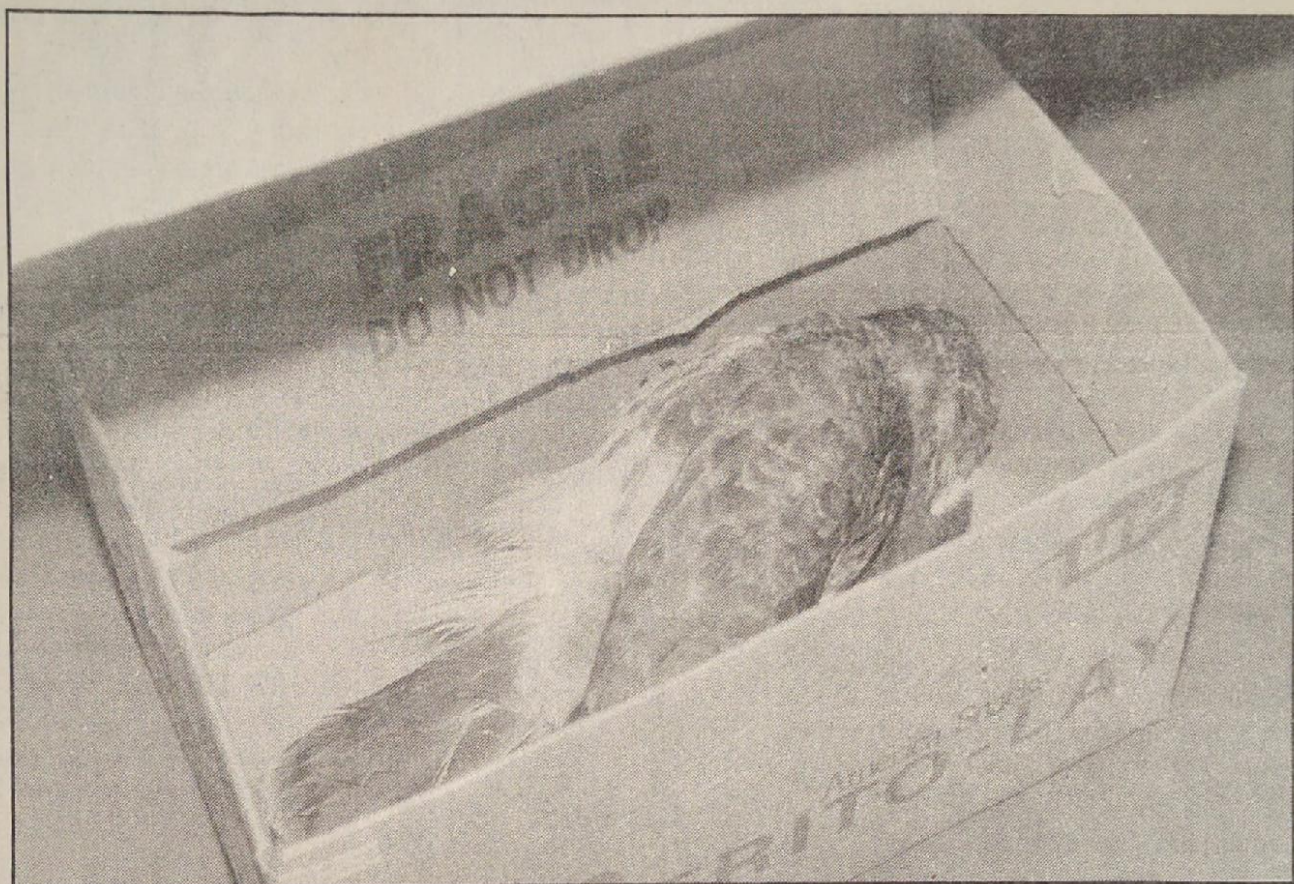


Handle With Care

Anson Record
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INJURED HAWK OCCUPIES BOX BEFORE ITS TRIP TO CHARLOTTE

(Photo by Eric Skinner)

Hawk Finds Sanctuary

By **ERIC SKINNER**
Record Reporter

An injured Red Tailed Hawk that was found on N.C. 74 near the Civitan Park has been taken to the Carolina Raptor Center in Mecklenburg County, a facility that cares for injured birds of prey.

The bird was found Wednesday morning by an unidentified man who took the bird to the Wadesboro Police station. The Raptor Center was called and they arranged for a volunteer to meet Anson County Sheriff's deputies at the Union County line and then take

the bird to Charlotte.

Martha Rockett of the Raptor Center said the bird has a concussion, an eye injury, a broken toe and could have internal injuries.

"The most serious thing is that she is wheezing and could have internal injuries," Rockett said. "There's some bruising, but it's hard to tell at this point."

The eye injury also could be serious, because the hawk will have to be able to use both eyes before it can be released.

"A one-eyed hawk wouldn't make it on its own," Rockett said. "It's just

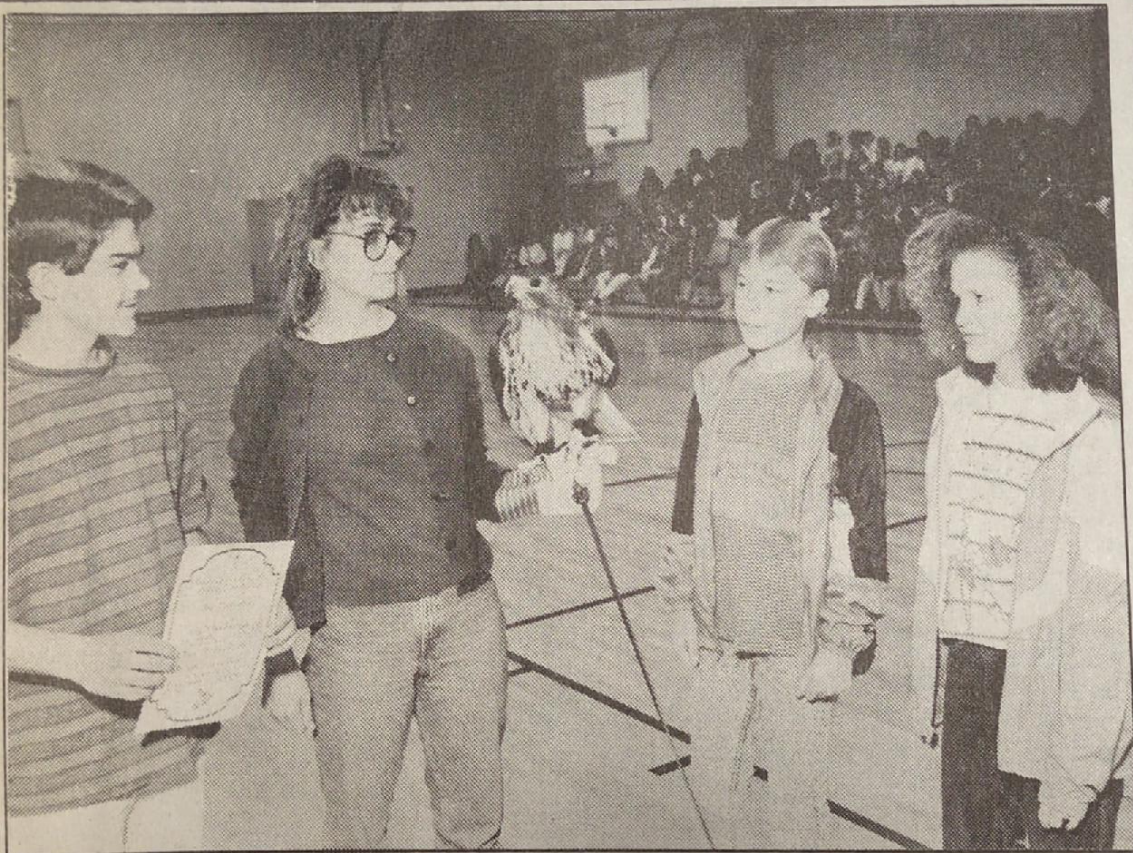
wait and see at this point. There's a pretty good chance that, with the eye injury, the blood will be reabsorbed and she'll regain her vision."

"Right now, it's the possibility of internal injuries that we're most concerned about," Rockett added.

Rockett also said it is not unusual for a hawk to be hit by a car.

"Unfortunately, it's one of the main ways they come in," Rockett said. "Right now, a lot of them are getting shot."

The hawk will stay at the Raptor Center until it is well enough to be released.



Photos by Frankie Furr

J.N. Fries students give a hoot

As part of their environmental studies, the 8th grades of J.N. Fries Middle School have raised money to adopt raptors at the Carolina Raptor Center, which takes in injured birds and nurses them back to health. Above, raptor center education intern Sylvia Larson shows a red-tailed hawk to students Steven Matheny, left, and Rusty Plummer and Crystal Brackett. At right is one of the seven owls adopted by last year's 8th graders, which are being re-adopted by this year's class, along with the hawk, a kestrel and a vulture.

